incense to be offered, oil and perfumes to be poured out, the ground to be sprinkled with flowers, and wreaths to be hung up, wherever—either amongst the ruins of these old temples or elsewhere—any fragment of an idol is to be found'.

In 1580, in Fatehpur Sikri, Acquaviva was both tormented and seduced by the possibility of converting the great Mughal Padshah. Mistaking Akbar's gracious interest and genuine curiosity for a desire to convert to Christianity, he became increasingly convinced that this was the divine purpose of his life. He was also deeply frustrated that this mesmerizing prize always seemed to be beyond his reach. He wrote to Father Claud about his experience at the court and noted with desolate abhorrence that the Muslim courtiers constantly glorified the name of Muhammad and 'bend the knee, prostrate, lift up their hands, give alms, and do all they do' in the name of the Prophet. And, despite Acquaviva's very best attempts to vilify the Prophet Muhammad and denigrate Islam, his fervent desire for martyrdom remained elusive and he bitterly complained: 'Will these Musalmans never martyr us?' to which the other priests used to reply, 'the King is too fond of us; no one dare touch us'.

While the Jesuits' unrelenting effort would come to naught as far as the soul of the Padshah was concerned, the greatest influence they were to have on Akbar and on the Mughal Empire was in the field of art. Akbar was genuinely delighted with the paintings they gifted him and the images in the illustrated Bibles. He already owned a few Christian images before the arrival of the Jesuit mission, which he had proudly pointed out to the priests. In his dining room were images of Christ, Mary, Moses, and Prophet Muhammad, and the priests noticed that he showed the image of the Prophet less reverence than he did to the others. This, though, may have been wishful thinking as Syed Ali Nadeem Rezavi has described these paintings to be of Timurid origin. After the Jesuit missions, however, European art would have a dramatic influence on Mughal paintings. Because most of the ships leaving Europe set off from Antwerp (which was a major centre of printing at the time) woodcuts and engravings of the Albrecht Durer tradition arrived at Fatehpur Sikri, and would heavily influence the Mughal school. There would be frescoes painted of Christ, Mary, and the Christian saints in the private chambers of Fatehpur Sikri and, indeed, in Mughal buildings across the empire. '(The Emperor) has painted images of Christ our Lord and our Lady in various places in the